

Everyday coding

Although we can't see them, codes are all around us, helping us every day. Computers use code to make modern technology run smoothly. Here are some examples of coding in everyday life.

Traffic lights

Coding is used to control the flow of traffic in many towns and cities. A computer sends coded instructions to the traffic lights to tell them when to change color. Drivers and people on foot then know when to stop and when to go.



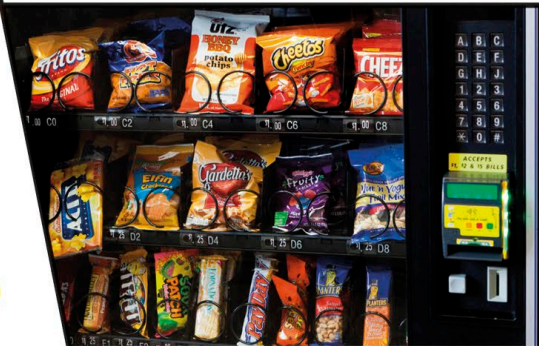
Computer games

Computer games can take players to imaginary worlds. Every game has code working behind the scenes that becomes instructions to make your character jump high or your car go faster.



Vending machines

After you have inserted money and made your selection from a vending machine, the code will figure out how much change you need, and then drop your item down to a tray for you to pick up.



Microwaves

Simple coded instructions control the timer on your microwave and the temperature your food is cooked at. The code starts working when you press the buttons on the microwave.